

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Waiting for a friend!



## Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about beliefs, opinions, relationships or character traits.
- I can express uncertainty about past events.
- I can contrast the main idea of a statement using words like *although*.

## Ask your partner:

- Do you ever give up waiting for people who are late? How long can you wait?
- What do you do or think about while waiting for someone?





## Let's Explore!

I was really **caught up\*** in all the excitement at the concert last night.

\* To "be caught up" in something means to become deeply involved in something.

*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

**Vanessa:** So how's the job going?

**Peter:** Today was my last day. The contract ended on Friday, so I am now unemployed again.

**Vanessa:** Happy?

**Peter:** A little bit, yeah.

**Vanessa:** Where's Amy?

**Peter:** I don't know. She was supposed to be here by now. She is usually very punctual.

**Vanessa:** Amy might have been delayed at work. You know her, she could have been caught up in an in-depth conversation with one of her clients.

**Peter:** She didn't go into the office today, so she couldn't have been held up at work.

**Vanessa:** Well, maybe she was delayed by traffic.

**Peter:** Even though there were a lot of cars on the road, traffic moved pretty smoothly today.

**Vanessa:** Why are you so worried about this? She's just a little bit late whereas you are the one who is usually lagging behind.

**Peter:** She said she had some news to tell me, so I'm a little uncertain.

**Vanessa:** Oh, no! Things haven't been going well?

**Peter:** No. Things seem fine. However, while things seem fine, I sometimes get the feeling that Amy is a little ... restless. Although, we have been together a month now, we still haven't had a serious conversation about our relationship and where things are going.

**Vanessa:** Well, maybe it's time.

**Peter:** Do you know something?

**Vanessa:** No, don't be so paranoid. I probably wouldn't tell you even if I knew anyway. That would be between the two of you to work out. Listen! It's probably nothing. You must not have understood what she meant. You do that Peter, you don't always listen and then, because you're a pessimist, you often think the worst. Just relax!

**Peter:** Here she comes.

**Amy:** Hey, guys. Sorry I'm late. I just came from a meeting with Candice.

**Vanessa:** Going on a trip?

**Amy:** Yes, I'm going back to Lesotho.





## Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Peter wonder why Amy is late.

*Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistake. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

- 1) So she couldn't have being held up at work.
- 2) Amy might have being delaying at work.
- 3) She could have been caughting up in an in-depth conversation with one of her clients.
- 4) You must not have understand what she meant.
- 5) Maybe she was delaying by traffic.



## Let's Practice!

Peter and Vanessa continue their discussion.

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Mark the correct answer from the group of sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

- 1) \_\_\_\_\_, while things seem fine, I sometimes get the feelings that Amy is a little ... restless.
  - a) Even if
  - b) However
  - c) Even though
- 2) \_\_\_\_\_, we have been together a month now, we still haven't had a serious conversation about our relationship where things are going.
  - a) Although
  - b) However
  - c) Even if
- 3) \_\_\_\_\_ there were a lot of cars on the road, traffic moved pretty smoothly today.
  - a) Whereas
  - b) However
  - c) Even though
- 4) She's just a little bit late \_\_\_\_\_ you are the one who is usually lagging behind.
  - a) whereas
  - b) even if
  - c) even
- 5) I probably wouldn't tell you \_\_\_\_\_ I knew anyway.
  - a) although
  - b) even if
  - c) however





## Extension Activity

Talk about the most important thing you've waited for.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- With a partner, brainstorm some things that people wait for throughout their lives.
- What are the most important things?
- What's the most important thing you've waited for?
- Write a 200 word story talking about this thing and why it was so important.
- Include reasons why you had to wait and why you were a better person after having had to wait.
- Share your story with a partner and ask for feedback.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I brainstorm ideas with a partner.

☐
☐

I discuss what are the most important things that people wait for.

☐
☐

I write a 200 word story about the most important thing I've waited for.

☐
☐

I present my story to a partner.

☐
☐

I give feedback.

☐
☐


## Target Words

- in-depth** (adjective): detailed, comprehensive and thorough  
e.g. She could have been caught up in an in-depth conversation with one of her clients.
- to hold up** (verb): to be forced to wait  
e.g. She couldn't have been held up at work.
- to lag behind** (verb): to fail to keep the expected pace  
e.g. You are the one who is usually lagging behind.
- uncertain** (adjective): not completely confident or sure of something  
e.g. She said she had some news to tell me, so I'm a little uncertain.
- restless** (adjective): unable to rest or relax as a result of anxiety or boredom  
e.g. I sometimes get the feeling that Amy is a little ... restless.
- paranoid** (adjective): anxious because you do not feel you can trust others  
e.g. David is paranoid about people listening to his phone calls.





## Learning Points

### Perfect Modals

We use **could have, should have, would have** to talk about hypothetical things. It means, things that did not really happen in the past.

The structure of a sentence that uses Perfect modals is:

Subject + modal + have (not) + past participle

Could have + past participle

We use this structure to:

- Talk about something that was possible in the past or you had the ability to do it, but you did not do it.

For example:

*I **could have gone to** France with my friends, but I didn't save any money.*

- Make a guess about some event that happened in the past.

Example:

*You know her, she **could have been caught up** in an in-depth conversation with one of her clients.*

Couldn't have + past participle

We use this structure to:

- talk about something that was not possible in the past, even if you had wanted to do it.

Example:

*I **couldn't have bought** that house. It was too expensive!*

Should have + past participle

We use this structure to:

- talk about some idea that would have been a good one, but you did not do it.

Example:

*I **should have studied** harder to pass the test.*

- talk about something that has already happened under normal conditions.

Example:

*Camilo **should have arrived** by now. He is so punctual. (It means that he has not arrived.)*

May/might have + past participle

We use this structure to:

- talk about possibilities that have happened now or happened at some point in the past.

Example:

*She **may/might have arrived** hours ago. (Perhaps she arrived hour ago.)*

### Examples:

- *So she couldn't have been held up at work.*





## Learning Points

- *Amy might have been delayed at work.*
- *She could have been caught up in an in-depth conversation with one of her clients.*
- *You must not have understood what she meant.*
- *We should have invited her to our party.*

## The Concession/Contrast Clause

You use concession or contrast clauses to express an idea that suggests the opposite of the main part of the sentence. They are useful in both writing and speaking since they make your language more dynamic and diverse.

You introduce concession or contrast clauses with conjunctions like **although**, **though**, **even though**, **whereas**, **while** or **even if**.

Example:

**Although**, *we have been together a month now, we still haven't had a serious conversation about our relationship and where things are going.*

**Although** and **though** have similar meanings. **Even though** is stronger in tone.

Example:

**Even though** *there were a lot of cars on the road, traffic moved pretty smoothly today.*

You can use words like *still*, *nevertheless* or *just the same* in the main clause to emphasize the contrast.

**Whereas** and **while** are similar but **whereas** is more formal.

Examples:

*She's just a little bit late **whereas** you are the one who is usually lagging behind.*

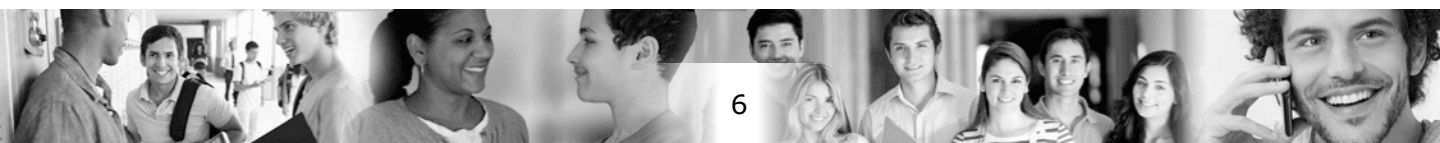
*However, **while** things seem fine, I sometimes get the feelings that Amy is a little ... restless.*

You use **even if** to emphasize that the situation will not change.

Example:

*I probably wouldn't tell you **even if** I knew anyway.*

**Examples:**





## Learning Points

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- *However, while everything seems to be going well, I'm not sure of her true feelings.*
- *Although, we have been dating for a while, I don't know where things stand.*
- *Even though there were a lot of people lined up, we got into the venue pretty quickly.*
- *He's only 5 minutes late whereas she is almost an hour late!*
- *She wouldn't come even if we told her he was going to be there!*

